

Foreclosure Help & Homes for \$1

Struggling with your mortgage, or hoping to buy a very low-cost home? There's free help to avoid foreclosure, plus real government programs that sell homes cheaply. Below are the main national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Free foreclosure help exists — never pay a company that “guarantees” it can save your home for an upfront fee. The safest first call is a HUD-approved housing counselor, who helps you for free.

1 Free Foreclosure-Prevention Help

If you're behind on your mortgage, a free HUD counselor can contact your lender, explain your options, and help you apply for relief.

☐ HUD-Approved Housing Counselor

Free expert help to avoid foreclosure and deal with your lender. Find one near you.

→ www.hud.gov/findacounselor

☐ HUD Foreclosure Help Line

Call to reach a free local foreclosure-prevention counselor.

→ 1-800-569-4287

☐ CFPB — Mortgage & Housing Help

Official tool for mortgage relief options and avoiding foreclosure scams.

→ www.consumerfinance.gov/coronavirus/mortgage-and-housing-assistance

2 Help Paying Your Mortgage

Some state programs still help homeowners who've fallen behind. Funds are limited, so check your state.

☐ State Homeowner Assistance Fund (HAF)

Some states still have mortgage-relief funds for homeowners who fell behind. Check your state's program through a HUD counselor or your state HFA.

→ www.ncsha.org/homeowner-assistance-fund

3 Buy a Home Cheaply — Government Sales

Government agencies sell foreclosed and surplus homes, sometimes far below market price.

☐ HUD Homes for Sale

Homes HUD has taken back, often priced below market. Browse by state.

→ www.hudhomestore.gov

☐ Good Neighbor Next Door — 50% Off

Teachers, police, firefighters, and EMTs can buy eligible HUD homes at half price (live there 3 years).

→ www.hud.gov/program_offices/housing/sfh/reo/goodn/gnndabot

☐ USDA Homes for Sale

Foreclosed rural homes sold by USDA, sometimes with low-down-payment financing.

→ www.resales.usda.gov

4 The Truth About “Homes for \$1”

You may have heard of \$1 homes. They’re real but limited — here’s where they actually come from.

☐ HUD Dollar Homes Program

HUD sells some unsold homes to local governments for \$1, which then offer them to residents through local programs. Ask your city/county housing office.

→ www.hud.gov/buying/government/dollarhomes

☐ Local Land Banks

Many cities sell abandoned homes very cheaply to fix up. Search your city plus “land bank” or ask in the Questions area.

→ **Search your city + ‘land bank’**

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Foreclosure “rescue” scams target struggling homeowners — never sign over your deed or pay big upfront fees. The \$1 home programs go through local governments, not random websites charging for a “list.”

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Call a HUD counselor the moment you know you’ll miss a payment — the earlier you act, the more options you have. Lenders often have relief programs they only offer if you reach out.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Ask for your personalized housing search

This guide covers the main national programs. For foreclosure help or low-cost homes specific to your city or county — including local land banks and dollar-home programs — use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
